Product: Airtel Thanks app

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Feature: Airtel Payments Bank NCMC recharge flow redesigned

Background & Strategic Fit

The app has been facing issues in screen freezing and slow loading for over 5 seconds on both Android and iOS mobiles. The case study aims to reduce the number of screens by optimising the payment process, to improve the number of recharge completions and decrease the drop-off rate, aligning with the company vision of improving physical card sales.

Product 1-Pager

Problem Statement

Reviews across platforms observed that the payment process is overwhelming the users, and drop-off is recorded due to user dissatisfaction among the DMRC regular and occasional commuters via the Airtel Thanks app.

Goals & Objectives

The goal is to reduce information overload, simplify the design, and provide smooth user onboarding to improve engagement. It involves UI and UX efforts to align the app with the business goal and product vision, as mentioned below:

1. UI retouches to make the icon on the homepage stand out.
2. Reduce the number of screens involved in the payment process.
3. Integrate the progress status bar into the transaction process.

Empathy & Research

Observation

8 users were asked to recharge the card using both the icon on the home screen and the search query result. Observations noted slow loading, and the entire payment process took a median time of ~267 secs unassisted, causing frustration.

Reviews

Probed the internet and got reviews on Reddit, X, and the Google Play Store criticising the app's UX, criticising the pop-up ads, screen freezing/excess loading time, and discrepancy in app vs card balance.

Interviews

Interviews were held for 3 members aged 18-55, where frustrations were recorded regarding the user journey from the home screen till the payment confirmation interface. The pain points were noted and duly delivered in the prototype iterations.

Competitor Analysis

Three problems were identified: slow loading time, excess screens, and information overload. Upon conduct of competitor analysis, it was concluded that the other UPI TRAPs (Third-Party Application Providers), like the dedicated DMRC Saarthi app and other banking apps like Paytm and Pine Labs, were able to support NCMC recharge facilities with a smoother and quicker interface supporting standard information exposure. Opportunity arose to declutter the screens while improving the UI through clarity in texts and UX via simplifying the payment screens involved.

Persona

Persona

Solution Design

Usability Heuristics for UI Design

Usability Heuristics for UI Design	Existing App UI	Redesigned App UI
Visibility of System Status	Missing payment progress status bar	Added status bar for to track the payment steps remaining
Match Between the System and the Real World	Present in the existing UI	No changes required
User Control and Freedom	Present on the existing UI	No changes required
Consistency and Standards	Confusing synonymous terms used in the card selection screen as resent in the app screenshot	Renamed and improved spacing among the icons for better understanding and navigation in selecting the actions (check statement, block card, etc.)

Error Prevention	Inconsistent payment successful and unsuccessful screens	Uniformity in UI for the for error prevention by adding proper breakthrough texts in the payment process during transaction processing stage
Recognition Rather than Recall	Present on the existing UI	No changes required
Flexibility and Efficiency of Use	Present on the existing UI	No changes required
Aesthetic and Minimalist Design	Present on the existing UI	No changes required
Help Users Recognise, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors	Present on the existing UI	No changes required
Help and Documentation	Present on the existing UI	No changes required

User Flow

Airtel Payments Bank NCMC RuPay Recharge flow - User Persona, Empathy Map, and Journey Map

UI/UX Design

LowFi Wireframing

HiFi Prototype

Success Metrics

North Star Metric

To curb the total number of successful recharge completions and curb the drop-off rate by decreasing the time required to complete the payment process of the regular and occasional users.

Secondary Metrics

Metrics	KPIs	OKRs

Reducing customer dissatisfaction	Reducing Drop Off Rate	Objective: Simplify the payment process by reducing the no. of screens the users interact with Key Results: Median time-to-checkout reduced to 35% in completing the transaction after redesign
Keep customers from leaving before completing transaction	Reduce Churn Rate	Objective: Show payment progress bar to keep the user informed Key Results: 80% payments are completed in one go
Increase returning users	Increase Retention Rate	Objective: Retouch UI and reduce information overwhelming Key Results: Increase in returning users due to simplified procedure, improve post-recharge card synchronization
Keep up with the competitor UPI TRAPs	Rediscover Product-Market Fit	Objective: Introduce micro-recharges of minimum ₹50, as offered by competitor DMRC Sarth App for their smart QR recharges, for one-way commutes Key Results: Increase app MAU for secured, frequent short travels

Guardrail Metrics

- Turnstile Tap Latency for offline payments and top-up processing to guard the security system
- Slow Card Synchronisation or Errors in Processing Payments instantly due to technical delays and/or mismatches

GTM

- The Airtel Thanks app will be required to update on the iOS app store/Google Play Store immediately after the features are rolled out.
- A launch on feature addition will be conducted on the social media accounts of both Airtel and the dedicated Airtel Payments Bank, namely on Instagram and X.
- A push notification will be sent out for users approximately 2 days after the launch, with a cycle of 1 week, to not bombard the users while informing them to update the app and adopt it accordingly.
- An infographic will be embedded in the mobile app and on the website for announcements in the header of the landing page/screen.

Annexures

User Interview questions